

⌈ Rationalize.

Let K be a field. Given $\theta \in K$, find an irreducible polynomial

$$P(x) = p_n x^n + p_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \dots + p_1 x + p_0 \quad \text{s.t.} \quad P(\theta) = 0.$$

Then, $\theta^{-1} = -p_0^{-1} \cdot (p_n \theta^{n-1} + p_{n-1} \theta^{n-2} + \dots + p_1) \in K$ is the multiplicative inverse of θ .

⌈ Problem. Rationalize the denominator of $\frac{1}{3 + 2 \cdot \sqrt[3]{2} + \sqrt[3]{4}}$.

Proof. In other words, find $(3 + 2 \cdot \sqrt[3]{2} + \sqrt[3]{4})^{-1}$ as $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear combination for $\sqrt[3]{2}$.

Let's calculate, by the Euclidean Algorithm,

$$x^3 - 2 = (x^2 + 2x + 3) \cdot (x - 2) + (x + 4)$$

$$x^2 + 2x + 3 = (x + 4)(x - 2) + 11$$

$$x + 4 = 11 \cdot \left(\frac{1}{11}x + \frac{4}{11}\right) \quad (\text{Not necessary term})$$

$$\text{So, } (x + 4) = (x^3 - 2) - (x^2 + 2x + 3) \cdot (x - 2)$$

⌋ Put

$$(x + 4)(x - 2) + 11 = x^2 + 2x + 3$$

$$\text{Then, we obtain } (x - 2) \cdot (x^3 - 2) - (x^2 + 2x + 3) \cdot (x^2 - 4x + 5) = -11.$$

Since $\theta = \sqrt[3]{2}$ satisfies that $\theta^3 - 2 = 0$, so

$$(\theta^2 + 2\theta + 3) \cdot (\theta^2 - 4\theta + 5) = 11, \text{ or}$$

$$(3 + 2 \cdot \sqrt[3]{2} + \sqrt[3]{4})^{-1} = \frac{1}{11} \cdot (\sqrt[3]{4} - 4 \cdot \sqrt[3]{2} + 5). \quad \square$$

⌈ In general, let $P(x)$ be an irreducible polynomial over F .

Then, $K = F[x]/(P(x))$ has a root of $P(x)$, namely α .

For F -polynomial $f(x)$, the inverse of $f(\alpha) \neq 0$ is:

$$(f(x) + (P(x)) = 1), \text{ since } F[x] \text{ is P.I.D and } P(x) \text{ is irreducible,}$$

so, $a(x)f(x) + b(x)P(x) = 1$ for some $a(x), b(x) \in F[x]$,

$$a(\alpha) \cdot f(\alpha) + b(\alpha) \cdot P(\alpha) = a(\alpha) \cdot f(\alpha) + 0 = 1, \text{ or}$$

$$f(\alpha)^{-1} = a(\alpha).$$